

Let Law Students Become Law Students First

A resolution on accelerated law-firm recruiting, before the ABA House of Delegates.

WHAT WE ASK YOU TO ADOPT

A resolution urging law schools, legal employers, bar associations, and other stakeholders to:

1. **Study** how accelerating recruitment timelines affect legal education, student well-being, and the entry-level hiring market; and
2. **Consider**, in their own recruiting practices, the educational, professional, and equitable interests of law students.

85%

of 2L summer offers now made before July of the 1L year, up from 34% a year earlier

80%

of offers now come through employer-sponsored recruiting, not on-campus interviews

18

law-school student governments asked the ABA to act

Four concerns, one modest response

1. Integrity of the first year.

The 1L year builds a lawyer's analytical, ethical, and professional foundation. When recruiting begins in week one, employer activity, not pedagogy, drives the calendar.

2. Student well-being.

Seventy-five percent of surveyed students tie increased anxiety directly to recruiting pressure, and a majority of the Class of 2028 report a negative impact.

3. Equity and access.

Only 25% of students knew these timelines before enrolling. A compressed calendar rewards pre-existing networks and disadvantages first-generation students.

4. Health of the hiring market.

Employers now hire on less information about performance and interest. Commentators call it a "lose-lose-lose" that no single party can solve alone.

The students asked first. On January 1, 2026, student governments at 18 law schools (Columbia, Cornell, Duke, Georgetown, Harvard, Michigan, Northwestern, NYU, Penn, Stanford, Texas, UC Berkeley, UCLA, Chicago, Virginia, Vanderbilt, WashU, and Yale) jointly asked the ABA to review accelerating recruitment, several backed by student polls showing supermajority support. **Sponsored by the Bar Association of the District of Columbia, with a coalition of law schools.** Approved by the BADC Board of Directors and recommended by its Young Lawyers Section; the drafters are aware of no opposition.



Please vote to adopt.

Scan for the full resolution, the report, the data, the coalition, and sources, at legal-recruiting-timeline-initiative.github.io/law-student-hiring-resolution

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Sources: NALP, *Perspectives on 2025 Law Student Recruiting* (Jan. 2026); LSAC & NALP, *2025 1L Class: Student Awareness and Impact of Accelerated Big Law Recruitment* (June 2026); Law.com (June 11, 2026); Bloomberg Law (Dec. 11, 2025); ABA Journal (May 14, 2026). Full citations at the site above. Builds on existing ABA policy 23A523 and 24A515.